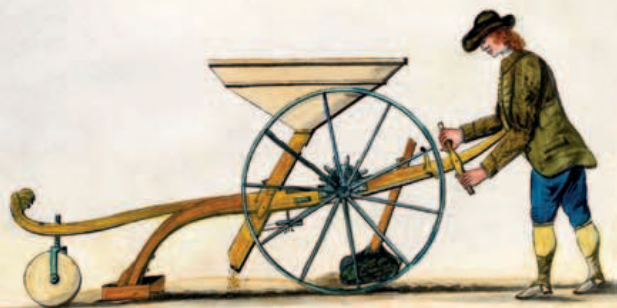




Jethro Tull's seed drill is shown here being operated manually. It sowed seeds in rows, performing work that previously required several laborers.

A REVOLUTION IN AGRICULTURE

BEGAN IN 1701 when English agriculturalist **Jethro Tull** (1674–1741) created the horse-drawn **seed drill** (see pp.250–51). A major time- and labor-saving device, it sowed great numbers of seeds in neat rows. Although not taken up at once, it later proved popular with large landowners and would lay the basis of modern **productive agriculture**.

No sooner had the Nine Years' War ended than Europe's powers found themselves in another lengthy and costly war. The surprise choice of Philip, duke of Anjou, as King Philip V of Spain (see 1700), greatly **disturbed the European balance of power**, and Louis XIV did nothing to discourage fears of a Franco-Spanish military alliance. He took over military duties in Philip's lands, moving troops into the Spanish Netherlands to defend them from the English and the Dutch. With renewed confidence in France's European status, Louis then **recognized James III**, son of the exiled James II (1633–1701), as king of England. With England and the Dutch Republic **backing Austria's claims** to the Spanish throne—in the form of their candidate, Archduke Charles of Austria—armed opposition to France was now guaranteed. The **War of the Spanish Succession** that began in 1701 saw a Grand Alliance oppose the unification of the French and Spanish thrones. It would last until 1713–14 and redraw the map of the continent and the world.



Battle of Vigo Bay, October 1702

In an early encounter in the War of the Spanish Succession, 25 ships of an Anglo-Dutch fleet defeated a Franco-Spanish fleet at Vigo Bay.

Freelance **Samurai warriors** known as **ronin** emerged from the Japanese civil wars of the 14th and 15th centuries. In 1651, they engaged in rebellion and continued to **instigate dissent** into the 18th century. In 1701, a respected lord, Asano Nugarō, was forced to commit suicide after assaulting an official who had insulted him. In revenge, 47 of his samurai became ronin and murdered the official, an act normally punished by execution. But because Confucianism taught that it is honorable to avenge a lord's death, they were allowed to commit suicide in turn.

The **kingdom of Prussia**—later the forerunner of the German state—**was proclaimed in 1701** when Frederick I, duke of Prussia and elector of Brandenburg, was crowned the first "king in Prussia," in Königsberg Castle.

Revenge of the 47 ronin

This color woodcut is one of a series on the 47 ronin uprising, the most famous incident of the samurai code of honor, bushido.



- 1701** Consolidation of Asante kingdom, West Africa
- January 14, 1701** Japanese warlord Tokugawa Mitsukuni dies (b. 1628)
- March 1701** War of the Spanish Succession begins (to 1713–14)
- May 23, 1701** Scottish pirate Captain William Kidd executed (b. 1645)
- June 1701** Act of Settlement excludes Catholics from British monarchy
- March 8, 1702** William III of England dies (b. 1650)
- July 24, 1701** Detroit founded as French trading fort
- 1701** Jethro Tull invents seed drill, England
- 1702** French Protestant Camisards begin revolt against repeal of Edict of Nantes
- 1702** Frederick IV of Denmark abolishes serfdom
- 1702** Sweden defeats Poland at Battle of Kliszow
- October 1702** Anglo-Dutch army led by John Churchill captures Liège
- 1702** The Daily Courant, first daily English newspaper, is printed
- 1702** Queen Anne's War begins in North American colonies of France and England (to 1713)
- January 30, 1703** Revenge of the 47 ronin, Japan
- May 27, 1703** Founding of new Russian capital, St. Petersburg
- October 23, 1702** Battle of Vigo sees Franco-Spanish fleet destroyed by Anglo-Dutch fleet
- May 26, 1703** Grand Alliance against France
- August 23, 1703** Ottoman sultan Mustafa III dethroned
- 1703** Hungarians, under Prince Francis II Rákóczi, rebel against Habsburgs
- November 1703** Great Storm kills 8,000 in southern Britain